The UNDP says "Human development is about human freedoms. It is about building human capabilities – not just for a few, not even for most, but for everyone." To reflect it better the UNDP is bringing new indices.

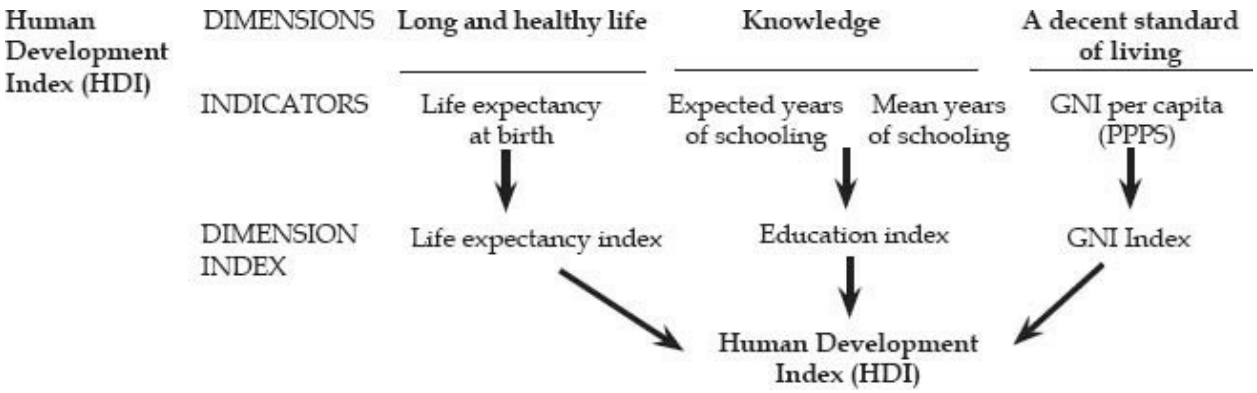
They are Inequality-adjusted Human Development Index (IHDI), Gender Development Index (GDI), Gender Inequality Index (GII) and Multi-Dimensional Poverty Index (MPI).

This chapter highlights the different dimensions, indicators, goal posts and calculation of HDI and new indices.

HDI: Dimensions, Indicators, Dimension Index and Goal Posts

Three dimensions used to measure HDI are long and healthy life, knowledge and a decent standard of living. Long and healthy life is measured by the indicators life expectancy at birth; knowledge by mean years of schooling and expected years of schooling and the decent standard of living by GNI Per capita (PPP$). It is computed as Life expectancy index, Education index and GNI index respectively. These are called dimension index. The geometric mean of these three indices gives HDI.

A graphical presentation of HDI:



Source: UNDP